

The Complete Financial Guide for Young Couples

That means, in a practical sense, that you must decide what kind of a home you can afford, what kind of car you can buy, what kind of vacation you can take, how much to spend on clothes, how much for entertainment and recreation, and so forth—and commit to making all those decisions TOGETHER.

As you begin to communicate about these everyday things, you'll learn a lot about each other. Keep in mind that you're almost always going to approach things from different perspectives. As I said earlier, if two people are identical, one is unnecessary. Differences can be a source of argument, or they can be a source of positive balance. When a couple accepts this principle, they both realize that each one of them has strengths and weaknesses.

A friend, who is a Christian psychologist, shared that he and his wife are opposites, and for a long time it caused a lot of strife. He said, "I know that whatever I want to do, she'll want to do the opposite. Whatever I want to buy, she wants to buy something else. If I say black, she says white." But, he said, he knew how to "get" her. She was sensitive about her lack of education because he had a Ph.D. So he would berate her lack of education during an argument. But what used to irritate him, he said, was that with a high-school education, she would consistently give better advice than he would with his Ph.D.

He said, before they became Christians, they used to get into terrible fights, usually after she had bruised his ego. Then they both became Christians and he thought surely their problems were solved, especially when he learned about the submission principle for wives, which he referred to a lot.

Then one time he was asked to speak at a pastor's conference and, without him knowing about it, his wife was asked to speak to the women while he spoke to the men. In spite of his badgering, she refused to discuss what she was going to talk about. He said, "I knew she was going to blow my image." Then one day he saw a note she had scribbled while obviously working on her presentation. It read, "Life with Attila the Hun." He was so mad that by the time they left for the conference he wasn't speaking anymore. He drove for a couple of